

The flowering of Florence

Numerous Florentine artists in the Early Renaissance built on new ideas including the expression of emotion, humanism and the use of perspective. Among the most notable painters are Fra Angelico (born Guido di Pietro c.1395–1455), Fra Filippo Lippi (1406–69) and Benozzo Gozzoli (c.1421–97). The Dominican friar Fra Angelico painted harmonious depictions of biblical stories using clean lines and soft colours. From 1440 to 1443, he painted nearly 50 frescoes in the convent of San Marco in Florence, conveying spirituality and naturalism and using the principles of linear perspective. Famous for his affair with a nun and for being captured as a slave and gaining freedom by painting a portrait, Lippi's serene Madonna and Child paintings, and his richly coloured frescoes featuring numerous figures and strong tones, show the influence of both Masaccio and Donatello. A pupil and assistant of Fra Angelico, Gozzoli developed an ornate style, influenced by the International Gothic. He worked extensively for the Medici in Florence, and collaborated with Ghiberti. He also worked in Rome and Umbria.



Fra Angelico, *The Annunciation*, c.1442